

Revenue vs. Cost Model — 1K to 1M Users

Free-to-use platform · B2B sponsored questions · aggregate data licensing

Business model

Core product	Revenue stream 1	Revenue stream 2	What we never do
Free for all users — always. No subscription, no paywall, no ads.	B2B sponsored questions — companies pay to pose a question to verified users and receive aggregated results.	Aggregate data licensing — anonymized trend reports sold to researchers, pollsters, and media.	No individual data sales. No demographic targeting. No ads. No dark patterns.

Revenue vs. cost by user milestone

Assumes 10 B2B sponsored questions per year at \$10,000 each as a base scenario. Adjust as needed.

users	infra cost / yr	B2B revenue	data licensing	total revenue	net profit/(loss)	cost / user / yr
1,000	\$900	\$6K	\$0	\$6K	+\$5K	\$0.90
5,000	\$900	\$6K	\$0	\$6K	+\$5K	\$0.18
10,000	\$10K	\$48K	\$10K	\$58K	+\$47K	\$1.09
25,000	\$10K	\$48K	\$10K	\$58K	+\$47K	\$0.44
50,000	\$35K	\$80K	\$30K	\$110K	+\$74K	\$0.72
100,000	\$97K	\$100K	\$80K	\$180K	+\$82K	\$0.98
250,000	\$207K	\$100K	\$200K	\$300K	+\$92K	\$0.83
500,000	\$415K	\$100K	\$400K	\$500K	+\$84K	\$0.83

750,000	\$415K	\$100K	\$600K	\$700K	+\$284K	\$0.55
1,000,000	\$415K	\$100K	\$600K	\$700K	+\$284K	\$0.42

Break-even occurs at approximately 25,000–50,000 users with 10 sponsored questions at \$10K each.

Infrastructure cost breakdown

Monthly costs at key milestones (USD). All figures are estimates — actual costs vary by usage patterns.

component	10K users	50K users	100K users	250K users	500K users	1M users
database (Supabase)	\$25/mo	\$50/mo	\$100/mo	\$200/mo	\$400/mo	\$800/mo
hosting (Vercel)	\$20/mo	\$50/mo	\$100/mo	\$250/mo	\$500/mo	\$1,000/mo
SMS verify (Twilio)	\$10/mo	\$30/mo	\$80/mo	\$200/mo	\$400/mo	\$800/mo
AI API (Anthropic)	\$20/mo	\$80/mo	\$200/mo	\$500/mo	\$1,000/mo	\$2,000/mo
customer support	\$0/mo	\$500/mo	\$2,000/mo	\$5,000/mo	\$10,000/mo	\$20,000/mo
moderation	\$0/mo	\$200/mo	\$500/mo	\$2,000/mo	\$5,000/mo	\$10,000/mo
total / month	\$910/mo	\$2,980/mo	\$8,150/mo	\$17,300/mo	\$34,600/mo	\$34,600/mo

B2B revenue scenarios

Annual revenue from sponsored questions at different price points and volumes.

questions / year	\$5K / question	\$10K / question	\$25K / question	\$50K / question	\$100K / question
5	\$25K	\$50K	\$125K	\$250K	\$500K
10	\$50K	\$100K	\$250K	\$500K	\$1.0M
20	\$100K	\$200K	\$500K	\$1.0M	\$2.0M

50	\$250K	\$500K	\$1.2M	\$2.5M	\$5.0M
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For context: a traditional online survey panel of 50,000 responses typically costs \$20,000–\$100,000. senseUS's verified user base commands a premium.

Data licensing revenue

user milestone	licensing available?	estimated annual revenue	why
< 10,000	no	\$0	insufficient sample size for statistical significance
10,000–50,000	yes (limited)	\$10K	basic trend reports to niche research buyers
50,000–100,000	yes	\$30K	regional/demographic breakdowns become meaningful
100,000–250,000	yes	\$80K	national-level polling data, media and PR value
250,000–500,000	strong	\$200K	comparable to major polling firms, multiple buyer categories
500,000–1,000,000	premium	\$400K–\$600K	institutional buyers, government, large media contracts

Headcount planning

user milestone	moderation	support	estimated total team size
< 10,000	AI only	founder only	1 (founder)
10K–50K	AI + monitoring	founder only	1–2
50K–100K	1 part-time mod	part-time hire	2–3
100K–250K	1 full-time mod	1 full-time	3–5
250K–500K	2 full-time mods	1–2 full-time	5–8
500K–1M	3+ full-time mods	2–3 full-time	8–15

Note: headcount estimates do not include engineering or product roles, which depend on your co-founder/contractor strategy.

Key insights



Infrastructure is cheap

At 50,000 users per active user, consumer app



One B2B client covers a year of costs

A single sponsor level. The eco



Data licensing is the long-term prize

At 500,000+ annually with genuine com



People costs dominate at scale

Infrastructure financial deci



Free forever is a growth advantage

No paywall m B2B buyers -

Disclaimer: all figures are estimates based on publicly available pricing for Supabase, Vercel, Twilio, and the Anthropic API as of 2025, and on comparable B2B research market rates. Actual costs and revenues will vary. This model is for planning purposes only and does not constitute financial advice.